



FIREFIGHTERS battle the Canyon fire Thursday. The blaze had exploded to 5,400 acres by Friday afternoon.

Thousands forced to evacuate as Canyon fire grows

By Grace Toohey and Clara Harter

A wildfire that broke out in the hills near the Los Angeles and Ventura county line amid a heat wave this week continued to grow Friday, forcing thousands to evacuate, destroying at least two buildings and challenging firefighters battling flames in extreme heat.

The Canyon fire, burning toward Castaic, had exploded to 5,400 acres by Friday afternoon, though officials reported it was 25% contained.

Taking advantage of cooler temperatures Thursday night into Friday morning, crews were able to make some inroads against the fast-moving blaze that grew to several thousand acres in a matter of hours, said Ventura County Fire Department spokesperson Andrew Dowd. But he said the fight ahead remains challenging, given the hot weather, rugged terrain and a parched landscape that, together, can foster extreme fire growth.

"We are seeing some flare-ups in various parts of the fire," Dowd said. "We still have record-low fuel moisture in the area, so we're not

Agents test the limits of 'probable cause'

Their aggressive tactics in L.A. region raise legal questions over who is targeted

By Rachel Uranga and Brittny Mejia

Matilde suffered a heart attack after she was held by immigration agents at a Lowes parking lot and can no longer go to the store without breaking down. Narciso Barranco, a gardener accused of threatening heavily armed agents with a weed whacker, still wakes up with headaches after he was beaten during his arrest. Jaime Alanis Garcia died after falling 30 feet from a rafter as agents stormed his workplace.

The aggressive tactics led by Border Patrol agents hundreds of miles from their posts have left communities jarred, people injured and businesses gutted.

"I can't erase the masked faces from my mind," said Matilde, a 54-year-old mother who is still gripped with fear about the raid in Pacoima. In a bystander video posted on social media, she appears to faint after agents grabbed her from behind. A doctor told Matilde, who asked that her full name not be used, that she had a heart attack.

Civil rights activists, city leaders, immigrants and their advocates were hopeful that the indiscriminate sweeps targeting Latinos were over in July after a federal judge issued a temporary restraining order, ruling that Border Patrol agents' profiling tactics violated the 4th Amendment. They were even more heightened when the 9th Circuit Court of Appeals rejected the government's argument that the tactics were lawful and upheld the restraining order.

But this week, Customs and Border Protection struck in Los Angeles again, raiding a car wash and a Home Depot, grabbing anyone who ran from them.

"We are not leaving," said Border Patrol Sector Chief Greg Bovino, who has been leading the operations in California.

The temporary restraining order prohibits agents from stopping someone solely based on their race, language, job or location.

Mayor Karen Bass said it appears as if the Wednesday raid at a Home Depot in Westlake — dubbed "Operation Trojan Horse" — violated the order, but city attorneys are still trying to determine the facts.

The legal wrangling will continue over the ways agents decide whom to target and the level of use of force they use for non-criminal enforcement. The government on Thursday asked the U.S. Supreme Court to lift the judge's order.

Now other parts of the country are watching the events in California, expecting federal agents to target their immigrant communities, particularly in states with no judicial orders blocking them.

"We saw the videos, the images coming out of Los Angeles. We definitely thought we would be next," said Rey Wences, with Illinois Coalition for Immigrant and Refugee Rights, which runs a hotline that monitors raids. "We're just waiting for the shoe to drop."

[See Raids, A9]

Trump seeks \$1-billion fine against UCLA

Demand involves antisemitism charges by the U.S. 'We'll sue,' Gov. Newsom says.

By Jaweed Kaleem and Michael Wilner

Hours after the Trump administration demanded that the University of California pay a \$1-billion fine to settle federal accusations of antisemitism in exchange for restoring frozen grant funding to UCLA, Gov. Gavin Newsom called the proposal "extortion" and said the state will go to court to protect the nation's premier university system.

"We'll sue," Newsom said during a news conference with Texas legislators over California's effort to counter a contentious Republican redistricting plan in that state.

President Trump is "trying to silence academic freedom" by "attacking one of the most important public institutions in the United States of America," Newsom

said, adding that he would "stand tall and push back against that, and I believe every member of the California Legislature feels the same way."

The federal government on Friday said UC should pay the billion-dollar fine in installments and contribute \$172 million to a fund for Jewish students and other individuals affected by alleged violations of Title VII of the Civil Rights Act. The statute covers illegal discrimination related to race, color, religion, sex and national origin, including Jewish and Israeli identity.

In addition, the Trump administration demanded sweeping campus changes encompassing protests, admissions, gender identity in sports and housing, the abo

[See Fine, A7]

Order on race in college admissions

Trump's executive action seeks to compel universities to prove a lack of bias. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

EPA to cancel \$7-billion solar grant program

By Hayley Smith

The U.S. Environmental Protection Agency on Thursday announced that it will eliminate a \$7-billion grant program designed to help low-income households install solar panels on their homes.

The Solar for All program was awarded to 60 recipients including states, tribal groups, regions and non-profits under the Biden administration's Greenhouse Gas Reduction Fund, a \$27-billion program geared toward addressing climate change.

The Solar for All funds would have delivered residential solar projects to more than 900,000 house-

holds nationwide.

In a post on X, EPA Administrator Lee Zeldin described the program as a boondoggle in which not enough was actually going for solar projects.

"One of the more shocking features of Solar for All was with regards to the massive dilution of the money, as many grants go through pass-through after pass-through after pass-through with all of the middlemen taking their own cut — at least 15% by conservative estimates," Zeldin said. "What a grift."

"With clear language and intent from Congress in the 'One Big Beautiful Bill,' EPA is taking action to end this program for good," Zeldin

[See Solar, A12]



A CEMETERY in Yarmouk reflects the destruction from Syria's 14-year conflict.

Syrian haven becomes a wasteland

Palestinian camp in Yarmouk is hollowed out by war

By Nabil Bulos

YARMOUK, Syria — On a ferociously hot summer morning, the inspectors stepped gingerly through an alley and cast a critical eye at the war-withered buildings in this sprawling Palestinian refugee camp on the edge of Damascus.

The alley was typical of what Yarmouk had become after 14 years of Syria's grinding civil war, which had cut the camp's population from 1.2 million people — 160,000

of them Palestinian refugees — to fewer than several hundred and turned what had been the de facto capital of the Palestinian diaspora and resistance movements into a wasteland.

The ramshackle structures that survive — often with missing roofs and walls, and stairs leading nowhere — have little in common, save for their shambolic, ad hoc construction designed less for permanence than speed and low price. Most have a sprinkling of holes picked out by bullets

or shrapnel.

"Nothing to repair here. This one we have to remove completely," said one of the inspectors, Mohammad Ali, his eyes on a pile of indeterminate gray rubble with an orphaned staircase coming out of its side.

He pressed a tablet to record his assessment and sighed as his partner, Jaber Al-Khatib, hoisted himself up on a wall and examined the skeletal remains of a bombed-out, three-story building.

[See Yarmouk, A4]

EV drivers could lose carpool privileges as incentive expires

By Karen Garcia

For the last two decades, more than a million motorists who have slapped "clean air vehicle" decals on their electric and hybrid cars have been free to cruise in carpool lanes with no passengers.

But that perk could be coming to an end Sept. 30 if Congress fails to extend California's Clean Air Vehicle

Decal program.

"Clean Air Vehicle Decals are a smart, cost-effective incentive that has played an important role driving the adoption of clean and zero-emission vehicles in California," read a statement from Liane Randolph, chair of the California Air Resources Board. "But thanks to the federal government's failure to act, this successful program is coming to an end."

You can still apply for a decal by Aug. 29, but it will become invalid Oct. 1, according to the Department of Motor Vehicles.

Extending the decal program in California — or any other state — would require the approval of Congress and the signature of President Trump, said Bill Magavern, policy director for the Coalition for Clean Air.

[See EV, A8]

Insurer of last resort questioned

California regulators take legal action against FAIR Plan, but critics say move may not lead to much. **BUSINESS, A10**

Solar site online in Kern County

One of the largest solar and battery plants in the U.S. is providing power to L.A. and Glendale. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Weather
Sunny.
L.A. Basin: 86/64. **B8**



Getty Images

'NO INVASION'

After Trump threatens to use U.S. troops against foreign cartels, President Claudia Sheinbaum vowed that won't happen in Mexico. **WORLD, A3**